

During the Vietnam War, the Americans would always rule out an invasion of North Vietnam, fearing a similar response from the Chinese. Korea taught American strategists the principle of “limited war”—restricting operations in order to prevent the conflict widening into a world war. The United States did not use nuclear weapons and did not attack China, even though American and Chinese soldiers were fighting in Korea.



### **Nuclear deterrent**

A Soviet nuclear device is tested in Novaya Zemlya on October 30, 1961. Fear of the destructive power of nuclear weapons forced America and the Soviet Union to avoid full-scale conflict with one another.

### **Weapons and training**

The communist victories in China and the Korean War had an immediate impact upon American policy toward Indochina. Once Mao was in power in Beijing, an open connection was established between the Viet Minh in Vietnam and the communist powers, with weapons and training for the guerrillas coming from the Soviet Union and China.

Meanwhile, France deliberately emphasized the communist threat in a search for desperately needed military support from the United States. The first deliveries of American military equipment to the French in Indochina arrived in June 1950, shortly after the start of the Korean War.

In American eyes, the war in Indochina came to be seen as France's contribution to the containment of communism in Asia. While other allies of the United States sent troops to fight in the Korean War, the French were allowed to concentrate upon their own anticommunist struggle.